

your average PC user could re-master audio in a snap. With its extremely easy-to-use interface and gaggle of effects—both fun and for serious audio cleaning—Cool Edit Pro swiftly gained ground as one of the most popular audio editors of all time. Not only was it an editor for individual files, you could also use the multi-track editor to create your own audio mixes with ease and immense control.



Adobe Audition

And then a company called Adobe Systems bought Syntrillium—the company that developed Cool Edit Pro—and rechristened Cool Edit Pro Adobe Audition. Since then, Adobe has been taking Cool Edit Pro to new heights, keeping it at its glorious Top-5 position. Support has been added for third-party VST and DirectX plugins. Adobe also somehow managed to bloat the installer from a very humble 20 MB to a gob-smacking 470 MB. It's also a bit heavier on system resources than the original.

If you love the features (and you can't help but), you could download the old Cool Edit Pro as well by searching for it on www.softpedia.com.

Sound Forge

Sonic Foundry's Sound Forge (now Sony's) is another contender for top spot for audio editing. It, too, sports an easy-to-use interface, though it's a bit daunting at first. It's one of the most robust tools we've seen—recovering from a crash is hardly an issue, because there are always crash recovery files that come to your rescue. It works brilliantly with sound cards and



Sound Forge and CD Architect